

Voice-based e-comm to grow

Flipkart sees 2026 as an inflection point where pervasive, AI-driven intelligence, will reshape how consumers discover, decide, and get products delivered. Voice is expected to emerge as a core mode of interaction in e-commerce, supported by models capable of effective noise cancellation and broad vernacular language coverage for India.



Influencer-led commerce adoption will also see significant growth. In a nutshell, commerce platforms that successfully integrate digital and physical artificial intelligence to provide smart automation, logistic optimization, continuous adaptive learning, intuitive customer experiences and robust human oversight and safety controls will be positioned to serve India's diverse consumer base.

—BALAJI THIAGARAJAN, CHIEF PRODUCT AND TECHNOLOGY OFFICER, FLIPKART

Agentic AI will shop for you online very soon

I believe AI will play a big role in e-commerce. If you are cooking palak paneer, for example, you'll be able not only get the recipe, but your agent will buy at the best possible price. Second point is around delivery, it will be faster, with lot more stuff, and a lot more locales will get quick commerce. So those are trends that will continue, and Amazon will continue to work on AI too, will continue to do things faster, cheaper, as well as provide better assortment to you. That's what we've been doing for the last 25 years around the world, and we'll continue to do that in 2026 and beyond.

—SAMIR KUMAR, COUNTRY MANAGER, AMAZON INDIA



Top 5 AI-led predictions

The world will soon have access to unmetered intelligence, where digital colleagues will join the workforce and AI factories will be the norm. Inefficiency economy will make way for an outcome economy. Jobs will get unbundled, skilling will be our only oxygen mask. And in this rearrangement of this world lies the biggest opportunity for all of us. For all of you, for me, for India, our digital destiny is being rewritten. The future is already here, and there's never been a better time to build with AI. Get started now. You are the frontier, you are the future. Let's build together.

—PUNEET CHANDOK, PRESIDENT, MICROSOFT INDIA & SOUTH ASIA



Sovereign AI boom

We are moving from AI as a consultant (Q&A) to AI as a worker (execution). In 2026, agents won't just analyze supply chains; they will autonomously negotiate with vendors and execute orders. Businesses will stop renting intelligence and start owning it. Sovereign agents will run inside your secure "digital borders." Historically, the internet has imposed an

"English tax." In 2026, Generative AI abolishes it. The critical tool for the next 500 million users is Hyper-Local Voice AI. "Linguistic Sovereignty" becomes the underlying invisible infrastructure that will gather momentum. Once the Indian mass market experiences the friction-free ability to transact in their mother tongue, the keyboard interface will become obsolete for the majority in no time whatsoever.

—PREM NARAIN DAS, FOUNDER & CEO, KATONIC AI

